Curriculum Vitae

François David Prud'homme, PhD

PhD in Semiotics · Sessional Lecturer — UQAM, UQAT, UQO

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Research Profile

My work sits at the intersection of semiotics, film aesthetics and critical studies of generative artificial intelligence. Trained in possible-worlds logic and in the theory of interpretive cooperation, I develop conceptual frameworks for describing the semiotic regimes that generative systems institute. My doctoral thesis addressed the aesthetic accessibility of possible worlds in cinema; my current research programme extends the concept of *accessibility operators* toward that of *real perceptual operators*, with direct implications for the redesign of higher education.

Postdoctoral Research Project

Interpretive Cooperation in the Age of Algorithmic Semiosis

Mapping, dwelling, resisting: toward a semiotic redesign of higher education

The pivotal concept is Eco's *interpretive cooperation*: every semiotic object is a lazy machine whose gaps call for the reader's inferential journey. Generative AI performs the inverse operation, which I call *reversed interpretive cooperation*. Optimised to converge on an audience's semiotic attractors, generative systems deliver an object that arrives already interpreted, its credibility immanent to its form. Peirce's unlimited semiosis gives way to probabilistic convergence.

The project unfolds through three gestures. **Mapping** describes the semiotic regime of algorithmic objects: statistical attractors, premature closure, regimes of perceptibility. **Dwelling** develops *semiotic silence* and *inhabitation* as anthropological conditions of interpretation, structurally absent from computational semiosis. **Resisting** proposes the *second inquiry* (*enquête seconde*) as an operative protocol — an "algorithmic *Blow Up*" that turns generated output from destination into probe. The generative system functions as an *explicator* in the sense of Rancière's *The Ignorant Schoolmaster*; the second inquiry is the counter-conduct that restores to the interpreter the position of one who searches.

Empirical work runs across all three gestures: generative texts and images interrogated for their dominant attractors, university cognitive interfaces analysed as real perceptual operators, and student production read for traces of the inferential short circuit.

Read the full summary

Education

PhD in Semiotics — Université du Québec à Montréal, 2022
Thesis: *L'accessibilité esthétique des mondes possibles au cinéma* [The Aesthetic Accessibility of Possible Worlds in Cinema]. Supervisors: Sylvano Santini and Bertrand Gervais.

Bachelor of Arts — Université du Québec à Montréal, 2013
Minor in Classical Studies (2010) · Certificate in Screenwriting (2009) · Certificate in Creative Writing (2008)

Awards and Distinctions

Research and Creation Grant — Canada Council for the Arts, 2022. Practice-based research: writing of a novel.

Département d'études littéraires Fund Scholarship — Interdisciplinary Doctorate in Semiotic Studies, UQAM, 2020

FARE Excellence Scholarship, twice awarded — Fonds à l'accessibilité et à la réussite des études, UQAM, 2018–2020

Publications

Edited volume

PRUD'HOMME, François David (ed.). L'occupation des territoires nordiques canadiens par une force étrangère. Québec: Presses de l'Université du Québec, forthcoming 2027. Edited collection on Arctic security.

Forthcoming

PRUD'HOMME, François David. "De machine et de mémoire : remédiation sémiotique et auctorialité distribuée dans la cocréation visuelle par requête" [Of Machine and Memory: Semiotic Remediation and Distributed Authorship in Prompt-Based Visual Co-creation]. In the proceedings of the international conference *Auctorialités augmentées en régime numérique*, CY Cergy Paris Université and Université Sorbonne-Nouvelle. Submitted July 2026.

In Preparation

PRUD'HOMME, François David. "Reversed Interpretive Cooperation: The Model Reader Sedimented in the Machine." In preparation. Target journal: *Semiotica* (De Gruyter).

PRUD'HOMME, François David. "Semiotic Silence: Dwelling in Slowness, Indecision and Boredom in the Space of Interpretation." In preparation. Target journal: *Signata — Annales des sémiotiques*.

PRUD'HOMME, François David. "Second Inquiry: Interpretive Counter-Conduct and the Redesign of Higher Education." In preparation. Target journal: *Learning, Media and Technology* (Taylor & Francis).

Digital Scholarship

Glossaire de la sémiose algorithmique [Glossary of Algorithmic Semiosis]. Evolving digital edition, fdprudhomme.com/glossaire. Organised across three registers.

Books, Articles and Reviews

PRUD'HOMME, François David. *Watchmen, l'aube d'une humanité*. Montréal: Les Éditions Ta Mère, Pop-en-Stock series. [Philosophical essay, monograph]

Reviews published in *Cygne noir, revue d'exploration sémiotique* (UQAM). Articles published in academic and graduate journals at UQAM.

Conference Proceedings

PRUD'HOMME, François David. Paper published in *Les variations Jarmusch*, Lettres et civilisations étrangères, Université d'Artois, 2014. Proceedings of the international conference *Le Cinéma de Jim Jarmusch*, Université d'Artois, Arras, France.

Conference Papers

International Conference — Auctorialités augmentées en régime numérique [Augmented Authorship in the Digital Regime] — CY Cergy Paris Université and Université Sorbonne-Nouvelle, Paris, 2–3 June 2026
"De machine et de mémoire: semiotic remediation and distributed authorship in prompt-based visual co-creation." Panel "Algorithmic Authorship: Delegation, Remediation and Figures of the Visible," co-convened with Bertrand Gervais (UQAM).

93rd Acfas Congress — Emerging Research in Communication — Université du Québec à Trois-Rivières, 15 May 2026
"The eco-visible is already here — eco-vision remains to be invented."

Deleuze Studies International Conference — Università degli Studi di Roma Tre, Italy, 2016

International Bilingual Conference — The Cinema of Jim Jarmusch — Université d'Artois, Arras, France, 2015
Proceedings published in *Les variations Jarmusch*, Lettres et civilisations étrangères, Université d'Artois.

"Une folie du voir dans l'extrême contemporain" — NT2 Laboratory and FIGURA, UQAM, 2014
Co-organiser and speaker.

Teaching Experience

Sessional Lecturer — Department of Literary Studies and Screenwriting — Université du Québec à Montréal, 2018–present

Literature and Cinema · Reading the Moving Image · Semiotics · Film Reading: Film Criticism · From Film Noir to Neo-Noir · Reading Screenplays · Plot and Screenplay

Sessional Lecturer — Creation and New Media — Université du Québec en Abitibi-Témiscamingue, Rouyn-Noranda, 2022–present

Film Language · Screenwriting · Film Genres · Directed Studios in Creation and New Media

Sessional Lecturer — École multidisciplinaire de l'image — Université du Québec en Outaouais, Gatineau, 2023–present

Semiotics of the Image

Teaching and Research Assistant — Université du Québec à Montréal, 2016–2021
Student supervision, workshop facilitation, marking and research support.

Creative Work

Writing of a novel — in progress, supported by a research-creation grant from the Canada Council for the Arts (2022).

Independent filmmaker, screenwriter and director — Montréal, 2014–present
Short films, documentaries and films on art presented in festivals. vimeo.com/fdprud-homme

Related Professional Activity

Writer and Critic — SÉQUENCES, la revue de cinéma — Montréal, 2013–2017
Film analysis, criticism and studies in cult and classical cinema.

Languages

French (native) · English (fluent) · German (intermediate)